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Dear Anthropic team,

Two minutes before an executive briefing room door opens, I stop the presenter in the hallway, no matter how senior, and run through three things: the faces in the room, what has landed, the one thing this session has to do. I have kept that ritual for years. It exists because of the worst five seconds of my career.

The CEO of one of the world's largest freight forwarders had crossed an ocean for a four-day executive summit at Google. On the final afternoon, a VP walked into his fourth session of the day, turned to the CEO, and asked, "What part of the organization are you in? IT?" He had not read the brief. Five months of work died in five seconds.

My team and I owned it in the room, no excuses. It did not matter. A CEO who crosses an ocean is buying attention as much as technology, and one question showed him what he had bought. We lost the deal. I turned that wreckage into a course for our entire sales team, and I have run executive rooms differently ever since.

Those rooms are my body of work. Supply chain is my trade. Nearly seven years of it at Google: eighteen supply chain consulting engagements a quarter, almost always across the table from the C-suite, and impact measured on one number: a 7% lift in the client's international revenue within 90 days of consultation.

When a supply chain crisis got too big for any one room, I put the briefing on paper. The State of Supply Chain began as a COVID memo and grew into a strategic report read by the leadership of 700 client organizations. Before Google, my work was zero to one: I launched and expanded Staples' same-day delivery pilot, and co-founded ChargeRx, which put bedside charging in 250 hospitals.

The approach never changed, whether I was selling Memorial Sloan Kettering's head of patient experience, making the case for same-day delivery to Staples' CEO, or briefing Walmart's operations team on supply chain resilience. Start with the account team: where the deal stands, what the room has to change. Get the operators talking before the summit begins; they hand you the real agenda. Then build the story that fits that one room. And when the room empties, follow through relentlessly: every commitment tracked to close, every problem surfaced instead of buried, every learning recorded, so the next briefing starts smarter than the last.

For years, the fear across the table was Amazon at the gates or a port at a standstill. Now it is AI. At a Google hackathon I showed my own colleagues a model doing a week of their account prep in fifteen minutes, often better. Nobody cheered, and that was inside Google. Executives do not need more proof this technology is powerful; they need to see who they can become with it, and that takes a story and a plan, not a demo.

So I made myself the test case. Bridgehead Labs is my AI and supply chain consulting firm, built with Claude as its infrastructure from day one; agents stood up the LLC, the brand, and the client tooling I sell with. Claude has also failed me enough to keep me honest. Agents have reported success they never verified, and I keep score of those failures, because a client weighing an AI bet deserves to hear what the technology cannot do. Almost no one tells them. Anthropic was founded on the opposite instinct: publish what your own models cannot do. That is why its briefing room can be the rare place a leadership team gets the straight story.

That is the program I want to build with you: qualified demand in, commitments tracked to close, attributable pipeline. Most of all, a room leaders leave better informed, less afraid, and more ambitious. Armed with a plan their own people can run and a first win that spreads on its own. I have been building that room my whole career.

I will be in the hallway, two minutes before the next session.

Evan Monahan